

Department of Government Departmental Turnitin Statement and Student Agreement

The following statement sets out how Turnitin is to be used within the Department of Government and the terms by which students agree to use Turnitin.

Students agree to ensuring they have read and understood both:

- the School's [Regulations on Assessment Offences](#) and
- the Department of Government local guidance relating to academic writing, including referencing, citation and paraphrasing, available on course Moodle pages and on the UG and MSc programme Moodle pages.

The Department of Government agrees to use Turnitin as a student academic writing development tool by providing students access to their Turnitin similarity report and score (%) as follows:

- for at least one of their formative essay-based assessments for every year of their studies.
- an assessment submission portal will be made available to all students on the Department of Government's Programme Moodle pages ([UG](#), [MSc](#) and [MRES/PhD](#)) where assessments can be uploaded and Turnitin reports can be accessed.

The Department's rationale for the chosen approach is that by providing students with opportunities to access Turnitin similarity reports and scores (%) for at least one piece of formative work that they submit in each year of study in the Department, and by offering guidance in how to interpret these documents, we will help them develop their academic writing skills and reduce occurrences of unintentional plagiarism.

The Department of Government agrees to provide its students with support and training in the use of Turnitin through:

- Centrally offered support and training provided by LSE LIFE. LSE LIFE provides a three-tier approach to training (Online/self-access materials, Workshops and One-to-one support). Please contact lselife@lse.ac.uk for details on training in the use of Turnitin.

Students agree to use Turnitin on the basis prescribed by the Department in this statement.

Students should be aware that where Turnitin is used within the Department, it is applied universally (i.e. to all submissions within a specific assessment or not at all - blanket use).

Students need to be aware that academic judgement is the first indicator of academic misconduct and that either a high or low percentage score (%) can be equally investigated. Therefore, there is no similarity score (%) threshold (whether low or high) within the Department that excludes them from an initial investigation.

As stated in the Conditions of Registration:

"Copies of all papers submitted to the software will be retained as source documents in the iParadigms reference database (held in the US) solely for the purpose of text matching against future submissions. Use of the Turnitin UK service shall be subject to such Terms and Conditions of Use as may be agreed between iParadigms and LSE from time to time and posted on the Turnitin UK website."

Queries about use of Turnitin, academic misconduct or plagiarism should be addressed in the first instance to your Department (Undergraduates should contact gov.ug@lse.ac.uk and MSc students should contact gov.msc@lse.ac.uk).

